

DECISIVE MOMENT

CAPTURE OF COMRADE GONZALO, 1992

The self-styled Comrade Gonzalo, Abimael Guzmán, was captured in Lima on September 12, 1992. A philosophy teacher, Guzmán founded the Maoist guerrilla group Shining Path in 1970, drawing support from among the marginalized rural poor. Shining Path embarked on a campaign of bombings and murders throughout the 1980s, in which an estimated 140,000 people were killed. His capture was a severe blow to the group, which thereafter declined as a threat. The end of Shining Path power allowed Peru to promote tourism for the first time in years.

Behind bars

The Fujimori government displayed a defiant Guzmán for the benefit of the world's press. Without his charismatic leadership Shining Path soon lost momentum.



approves a new constitution allowing him to stand again as president. In 1995 Fujimori is reelected president.

1996–97 Left-wing Tupac Amarú guerrillas seize hundreds of hostages at Japanese ambassador's residence in a four-month siege.

2000 Fujimori resigns amid a corruption scandal, despite having won controversial third term earlier in the year; he seeks refuge in Japan.

2001 Fresh presidential elections, won by Alejandro Toledo of the Perú Posible (PP) party. Toledo thus becomes the nation's first Amerindian president.

2003 Beatriz Merino is appointed first woman prime minister.

2006 García returns to power.

2007 Former president Alberto Fujimori is extradited from Chile to face corruption charges (sentenced in 2009 to 25 years).

- «74–75 People of the Jaguar
- «140–41 Early American Civilizations
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Bolivia



The continent's poorest country, which is named after the "Liberator," Simón Bolívar.

1532 Spanish conquer the area that is now Bolivia, which is part of the Inca empire. The indigenous people are finally defeated by the Spanish in 1538. The region is governed as part of Upper Peru.

1545 Cerro Rico, the Silver Mountain, is discovered at Potosí. Within three decades, Potosí is the largest city in the Americas with 120,000 inhabitants. Silver mining provides Spain with a large income.

1559 Placed within the Charcas Audiencia attached to the Viceroyalty of Peru, which includes modern-day Bolivia and much surrounding land. This leads to disputes and wars after independence.

1776 Upper Peru becomes part of Viceroyalty of Río de la Plata centered around Buenos Aires.

1809 Simón Bolívar inspires first revolutionary uprisings in Latin America at Chuquisaca (Sucre), La Paz, and Cochabamba, but they fail.

1824 Spaniards suffer final defeat by Bolívar's general, José de Sucre.

1825 Independence.

1826 Bolivia draws up its first, republican, constitution; the country is named after Simón Bolívar, and Chuquisaca is renamed Sucre, after the liberating general.

1836–39 Union with Peru fails, leading to a long period of internal disorder.

1864–71 Ruthless rule of Mariano Melgarejo. Three Amerindian revolts over the seizure of ancestral lands are crushed.

1879–84 Bolivia is defeated by Chile in the War of the Pacific. Bolivia loses coastal Atacama and its rich nitrate deposits to Chile and is left landlocked.

1880–1930 Period of stable governments. Exports from mining bring prosperity.

1903 Acre province is ceded to Brazil. The rubber-rich area had long been contested by the two nations.

1904 Ismail Montes starts the first of his two terms as president (1904–09, 1913–17). He officially ends the War of the Pacific with Chile and starts a

program of wide-ranging social, administrative, and economic reforms, building new railroads and developing the mining industry.

1914 Republican Party founded.

1920 Amerindian rebellion.

1923 Miners' uprising suppressed.

1932–35 Chaco War with Paraguay, the bloodiest conflict in the world between the two world wars. Bolivia loses three-quarters of the Chaco region in 1938. Rise of radicalism and the labor movement.

1951 Víctor Paz Estenssoro of the nationalistic, pro-miner, Nationalist Revolutionary Movement (MNR) is elected president, but is prevented from taking office by a military coup.

1952 Revolution: Paz Estenssoro of the MNR takes power with the help of national police and a militia recruited from the mines. Land reforms improve Amerindians' status. Education is reformed, universal suffrage is introduced—giving full rights to the Amerindian community—and the tin mines are nationalized.

1956 MNR candidate Hernán Siles Zuazo wins presidential election; he is succeeded in 1960 by returning president Paz Estenssoro.

1964 Military takes over in coup after economic collapse.

1967 Che Guevara is killed while trying to mobilize Bolivian workers.

1969–79 Military regimes rule with increasing severity. A coup in 1979 fails, leading to interim civilian rule.

1980 Military takes over again.

1982 President-elect Siles Zuazo finally heads leftist civilian MIR government. Inflation runs at 24,000 percent.

1985 Paz Estenssoro's MNR wins elections. Austerity measures bring annual inflation down to 20 percent.

1989 Movement for the Revolutionary Left (MIR) takes power after narrow electoral victory. President Paz Zamora makes pact with 1970s dictator General Hugo Banzer, leader of the nationalist Democratic Action (ADN) party.

1990 4 million acres (1.6 million hectares) of rainforest are recognized as Amerindian territory.

1993 MNR voted back to power.

1997 Banzer wins the presidential elections.

1999 Opposition demands inquiry into Banzer's role in regional military repression in 1970s.

2000 Government's water supply privatization plans and coca eradication program provoke uprisings by peasants and coca growers.

2001 Banzer resigns due to ill-health.

2002 MNR wins elections under Sánchez de Lozada, who is forced out in 2005.

2006 Evo Morales Ayma of the Movement toward Socialism (MAS) becomes the first indigenous president. A new constitution guarantees greater rights to the indigenous majority. Land reform bill aimed at redistribution is passed. Gas is nationalized.

2009 Evo Morales wins second term.

2010 Electricity-generation industry is nationalized.

- «230–31 Contact Americas
- «234–35 Spanish Silver
- «280–81 The Slave Trade
- «318–19 Latin America Liberated

Bolivian marchistas

These miners, along with other so-called *marchistas*, descended on La Paz on November 30, 2006, to demonstrate in favor of President Morales's land reforms. Millions of acres will be redistributed under new laws.

